

Speaker 1 [00:00:00] Okay. And just for the sake of the recording, is it fine if I start recording?

Speaker 2 [00:00:05] Yes. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:00:07] Alright, so just an overview. I'll be asking some like demographic questions and then the rest is just going to be your spotlight about your experience and like your views on romantic relationships. So yeah, let's get started. So thank you for participating in this interview. As mentioned over email, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships, and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. So. Yeah. So how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:47] I'm [16-20].

Speaker 2 [00:00:49] Born [Date].

Speaker 1 [00:00:52] And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:55] We've been together for like, [1-5 years and 1-5 months].

Speaker 2 [00:01:00] I guess. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:01:02] And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:01:04] No.

Speaker 1 [00:01:05] And who lives in your household?

Speaker 2 [00:01:09] [1-5] of my cousins. And they're my siblings and my parents. So [6-10] people.

Speaker 1 [00:01:23] And what is your main source of income or your current job?

Speaker 2 [00:01:27] My current job, I work at [Company] just as a [occupation] now.

Speaker 1 [00:01:35] And how would you like me to address your partner? Girlfriend, partner? Lover? By the name?

Speaker 2 [00:01:43] whichever, girlfriend or just [Partner's Name]?

Speaker 1 [00:01:45] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:01:50] All right. So. Yes. So from now on, it's just going to be me taking notes on the side. But. Tell me about your love story.

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:05:04] Cool. All right. So when comparing the quality of your current relationship to that of your friends relationships, what would you say is the difference?

Speaker 2 [00:05:18] Mm I feel like I don't have very like... Well, I don't have friends in the community. Most of my friends are just, like, straight cisgender. So honestly, I can't really

like. I don't really like comparing just because they've dated guys and guys are extremely different. Difficult, I guess.

Speaker 2 [00:05:43] You know, not to...

Speaker 2 [00:05:46] There's there's a few things like comments.

Speaker 2 [00:05:48] Like just because I feel like, We pose the question, sorry, I'm probably going to go on a rant.

Speaker 2 [00:05:55] I forgot the question.

Speaker 1 [00:05:56] Compare the quality of that of your current relationship to that of your friends' relationships.

Speaker 2 [00:06:02] Oh, okay.

Speaker 2 [00:06:03] Well...

Speaker 2 [00:06:05] Me and [Partner's Name], we've lasted for like [6-10 years] already. Most of my friends, they. They don't have really long term relationships. And because they're what's called. Oh, and because they're also like sis and white, I mean, oh my, cis and hetero rather.

Speaker 2 [00:06:31] Then I really, I don't know, really like comparing so much our relationships, too. But you know, they don't really have long term relationships. I'm on the longest relationship.

Speaker 2 [00:06:41] Yeah. So I think the quality.

Speaker 2 [00:06:44] I think it's good...

Speaker 2 [00:06:48] Okay. Final answer.

Speaker 1 [00:06:52] And how many romantic partners have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:06:59] None. I haven't had any exes. I have had only one crush but besides.

Speaker 1 [00:07:17] Mm hmm. Okay. And. Yeah. So just in general, what do you think makes a relationship high quality?

Speaker 2 [00:07:23] I feel like quality relationship depends on communication and trust.

Speaker 2 [00:07:32] Honestly, just because like you can have a lot of doubt in yourself and a lot of doubt in your partner. Even though they don't give you a reason to doubt.

Speaker 2 [00:07:40] But it's mostly just trust. I feel like if you lose trust, then the relationship will slowly downhill.

Speaker 1 [00:07:52] And what about low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:07:57] Low quality?

Speaker 1 [00:07:58] What makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker 2 [00:08:01] Oh, like constant. You know, I feel like healthy relationships can argue, but, like, it makes. Unhealthy. Like, kind of like low quality things. It's like arguing, but not being able to, like, forgive each other or...

Speaker 2 [00:08:21] Understand the other person's point of view. I think that would probably make it low quality. I know that.

Speaker 1 [00:08:44] Cool. so, what are the most important things in a relationship, you think?

Speaker 2 [00:08:48] We...

Speaker 2 [00:08:51] I feel like most important things, is being able to bond with each other's family. Also being able to talk about your insecurities, obviously. Then being your number one best friend. That's also something important in the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:09:20] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:09:21] So can you tell me about. Um...

Speaker 1 [00:09:27] Being able to bond with each others parents that you mentioned

Speaker 2 [00:09:32] Oh okay, I mean, just think...

Speaker 2 [00:09:34] In general, like with family. Like she tries to bond with my siblings, and so we go on like sibling outings. I do the same with her siblings, her little brother and her, you know, her, both of her brothers. And so, like with parents lives. I feel like just because my parents were kind of difficult about it at first, obviously, I'm glad that they like her now. But, you know, that always doesn't have to be a top priority. Just like depending on. Basically anybody that's closer to you being able to. Also I say– sorry, I'm blanking. Being able to just bond with anybody that's close, like me and my siblings have a really close relationship. Obviously I want them to like her. And because her and her siblings have close relationships.

Speaker 2 [00:10:33] I want them to like me to try to bond as much as we can.

Speaker 1 [00:10:38] Yeah, definitely. And. What about being your number one best friend? Because I'm also like, I'm not straight so much.

Speaker 2 [00:10:50] Oh, okay.

Speaker 1 [00:10:51] But, you know, I mean, I did break up with her for, like, you know, anyway.

Speaker 2 [00:10:59] Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:11:00] But I feel like. I don't know. Like, I never really understood that. And maybe we had different values. But yeah. What do you mean by being number one best friend to each other?

Speaker 2 [00:11:14] Oh, my God...

Speaker 2 [00:11:16] I mean, like, everyone's going to be like, if I want her to be someone I can go to, like when I'm feeling down or anything like that. Obviously, I don't want to put pressure on that, but you know, just being able to grant to her as if she was just a friend. You know, like, obviously, I know she's my girlfriend, but like, having that comfort level of just being able to rap.

Speaker 2 [00:11:41] And..

Speaker 2 [00:11:42] Being able to just, like, drop by whenever, like being like, Oh, hey, let's go do some chores or something.

Speaker 2 [00:11:48] I don't know.

Speaker 2 [00:11:49] Stuff like that. Like with my friends, I'm usually just at their house, umm, I come unannounced.

Speaker 2 [00:11:55] But you know...

Speaker 2 [00:11:57] We just start like we just like hang out, watch TV and all that. And that's the kind of comfort level that I also like, like being able to think I look ugly, but then having her be like, Oh, you.

Speaker 2 [00:12:09] Like, you look good. Like, I like that you feel comfortable, you know, and not having to dress up for each other all the time, you know, stuff like that. Sorry for your relationship. Really?

Speaker 1 [00:12:26] No. No. it's never good. I'm happier than ever.

Speaker 2 [00:12:27] Good, good.

Speaker 1 [00:12:29] So tell me your views on this. So what is love?

Speaker 2 [00:12:38] I think love would be like no matter what. Their views are obviously being heard. I mean, sometimes we kind of disagree on things. But I love her. I respect her opinion. I'm not going to be judging her.

Speaker 2 [00:12:54] On stuff like that. For me, it's like constantly thinking like, Oh, this reminds you of her.

Speaker 2 [00:13:00] I'll probably get it for her, you know? Mm hmm. Just little things. What else?

Speaker 2 [00:13:07] I'm always thinking about like, you know, whenever we have some big news to tell, it's like she's going to be the first person I'm going to tell like, Oh, I just. Come in the car. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:13:18] I'm going to tell her. I don't know.

Speaker 2 [00:13:20] Things like that...

Speaker 2 [00:13:23] Just know what's called always healthily, healthily, thinking about her.

Speaker 1 [00:13:30] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:13:32] what's it's called not being too obsessive, too. But you're like, she's mine.

Speaker 2 [00:13:36] Like, what about all that? Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:13:40] I don't know. I don't know. Things like that. I just. I feel kind of shy—some.

Speaker 1 [00:13:48] Oh, yeah...

Speaker 1 [00:13:51] And how important do you think is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:57] I think...

Speaker 2 [00:13:59] Love. It is important, I think...

Speaker 2 [00:14:05] And be like...

Speaker 2 [00:14:06] The most important thing. But again, like going back...

Speaker 2 [00:14:09] To...

Speaker 2 [00:14:10] Before, I think at some points you can like really not like your partner and you're like, Oh my God. I'm kind of like tired. But at other point of view, like for the love of my life.

Speaker 2 [00:14:21] We'll see about like, trust.

Speaker 2 [00:14:23] And you know...

Speaker 2 [00:14:25] Love can be like one of the top three things...

Speaker 2 [00:14:28] Exactly...

Speaker 2 [00:14:29] But it is there. It has to be there for you guys to be together.

Speaker 2 [00:14:34] Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:14:36] So, yeah. So tell me more about, um, when there are some points where you don't like your partner.

Speaker 2 [00:14:43] Oh...

Speaker 2 [00:14:43] I'm sorry. Sorry to cut you off.

Speaker 2 [00:14:48] Uh, kind of like disagreements, things like that. You're obviously not always going to like how your partner is, but you're always going to be, like, full on with them, you know? I still like them, even though I don't like them right now. I will later on. And I didn't before. Just like you knowing you know.

Speaker 2 [00:15:08] Being able to be like...

Speaker 2 [00:15:13] Second...

Speaker 2 [00:15:14] I don't. I don't know. It's like because I know that at some points I do get like, I'm not ugly, but maybe I'm too harsh or sometimes I get angry and I don't expect her to like me in those moments, but I'm glad that she still loves me. And I'm also glad that I still love her. Even if there's some moments where it's like, you know, we need to take a step back and, like, reflect. Yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:15:45] So how do you know your girlfriend loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:50] Hmm...

Speaker 2 [00:15:53] I know she loves me. Just because, like, would cause she... Every time she thinks about me, she always gives me, like, little things. I know. Sometimes I also, like, I think about her, but I like. I'm like, should I give her. Like I tell myself. But all my period, I still have a period.

Speaker 2 [00:16:12] And so...

Speaker 2 [00:16:13] But like, on my period, she'll give me chocolates, things like that, just because I really like chocolate.

Speaker 2 [00:16:19] Especially on it. So what's it called?

Speaker 2 [00:16:23] She feeds into my little obsessions, like notebooks or tiny things like comics. She'll literally buy me that. And so I feel like it's nice sometimes, like I don't really buy myself things.

Speaker 2 [00:16:39] Um...

Speaker 2 [00:16:40] I tend to like spend money on other people.

Speaker 2 [00:16:44] Mhm...

Speaker 2 [00:16:45] Like I don't have some of my favorite games or some my favorite comics just because I'm like okay, I'll bring them online.

Speaker 2 [00:16:51] I don't need them physically even though I would like to.

Speaker 2 [00:16:53] But she's like, you know, I'm gonna just get it for you and then she gets like some of those. and Oh, okay. Thank you.

Speaker 2 [00:17:00] I like stuffed animals. I would want them. But then I'm like, you already have, like, a good amount, but she'll get them. Like, how she's obsessed with, like, squishmallows.

Speaker 2 [00:17:12] So I'll get them for her.

Speaker 2 [00:17:14] Whenever I see em, especially at Costco. So I'll just get them real quick. I'll tell the people in the back.

Speaker 2 [00:17:23] And get those down for me please. Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:17:27] Like small things like that. She just really feeds into my little obsessions. Mhm.

Speaker 1 [00:17:35] Yeah. So you mentioned this, a bit of having this disagreement as one of the challenges in your relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:17:45] Could you tell me more about that?

Speaker 2 [00:17:47] I mean, like, you know, people are going to relationships they could either end on disagreements or like continue afterwards. And so I really like that, even if we do disagree. We forgive each other and like, really? Okay, So afterwards, even if it's big like we're so dramatic about it, it won't be long afterwards

Speaker 2 [00:18:08] Be like, why did you like. How did you feel about it?

Speaker 2 [00:18:15] Basically we...

Speaker 2 [00:18:16] we feel like ask each other that...

Speaker 2 [00:18:18] And once we like understand how the other person felt like having empathy, sort of because there's moments where like, you know, you're obviously going to disagree, disagree with someone, but you're going to feel like. You're just going to think about your own emotions.

Speaker 2 [00:18:35] But we try to think about each other's emotions and, like.

Speaker 2 [00:18:40] You know...

Speaker 2 [00:18:41] How did you feel about, like, a little not an interrogation, but, like, you know, letting things out?

Speaker 2 [00:18:48] Mm hmm. But yeah...

Speaker 2 [00:18:52] I think. I guess that's a you know, I think that's important just because. I'm not going to know how she feels if she doesn't tell me how she feels or she's not going to know how I feel if I don't tell her. And that's because you won't see the other person's point of view in a disagreement. Then you won't be able to understand them as well.

Speaker 2 [00:19:17] But we try to understand each other.

Speaker 2 [00:19:19] I don't know. I feel like I'm going on around about some rant of stuff here.

Speaker 2 [00:19:23] Yeah...

Speaker 2 [00:19:24] Things like that.

Speaker 1 [00:19:27] Okay. So what do you and your girlfriend fight? Fight could be defined as anything, to be honest.

Speaker 2 [00:19:35] Oh, okay. Not really. It's just like moments where, you know, we get upset. That's something we do. And honestly, like, you know, there's some things that are. We do exaggerate. Like, you know, like she'll flick my thumb and I'll be like, What the fuck? You know? I'm like, What the hell? Then? Then I'll get angry about it. And I'm like, Yeah, but it's really like, you know, all exaggerated just because I've already had a bad day. But she did it. She didn't know that I already had a bad day. So I have to tell it like, you know, and don't really like that. You flick my thumbs because like, my dog just died, you know? And she won't know that my dog just died. So, you know that hypothetical.

Speaker 2 [00:20:15] I don't want my dog to die. But yeah...

Speaker 2 [00:20:20] You know, there are just small arguments here and there, but it's mostly on how we feel because both of us are do go to things like mentally and with our families because we live apart.

Speaker 2 [00:20:33] So we just try to be a lot understanding of our situations.

Speaker 2 [00:20:38] I don't know my siblings get annoying, so...

Speaker 2 [00:20:46] I think most of the time I'm just...

Speaker 2 [00:20:47] Annoyed, but not to her, just my siblings.

Speaker 2 [00:20:54] like talking to my therapist or something.

Speaker 1 [00:21:05] So. Yeah. Okay. How how often would you say that these conflicts occur?

Speaker 2 [00:21:10] Oh...

Speaker 2 [00:21:11] Not very often. Maybe, like. Couple of times less than a week, but it's not like, you know, anything big. It's just like, okay, you'll get irritated.

Speaker 2 [00:21:21] You know...

Speaker 2 [00:21:23] Where it's not like not having a sibling, that's kind of weird, but, you know.

Speaker 2 [00:21:29] Little tiny moments like it all happen in like a span of 30 minutes and then afterwards will be like.

Speaker 2 [00:21:35] damn you're so dramatic about that, like, you know. Mm...

Speaker 2 [00:21:39] And we'll just be getting food and we'll be fine.

Speaker 2 [00:21:42] But it's just a tiny tiny thing. Mm hmm.

Speaker 1 [00:21:53] Oh, all right. So what are other ways that you maintain your relationship besides the things that you've mentioned? Like, um, reflecting, asking each other questions, having empathy? What are other ways that you maintain your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:22:09] Um, I guess having like, distinct days where we'll go out. And, because honestly, we don't have any privacy just because both of us do live with our families and we have younger siblings and all that. She has her work and then I have mine. So we try to have like designated days just so we could see each other. Or I try to see her as often as I can after work, before work. Anything like that.

Speaker 2 [00:22:37] But because we both enjoy food, so we call like Korean barbecue. Like on a Saturday, Random Saturday or...

Speaker 2 [00:22:47] on we go. Like if one of our classes cancels, we go get food and then we just eat together. Most of the time we just eat together. We like getting together a lot, so we try to eat as many meals together throughout the days. Yeah. Her like have a day where we'll just go out.

Speaker 1 [00:23:13] Mhm. Cool. Would you say that the relationship overall is good for you ?

Speaker 2 [00:23:18] I do think so...

Speaker 2 [00:23:20] I do think the relationship overall is good. It's like a really good distraction. Even though I know it's social responsibility, but like any time I'm stressed. I'll go to her and be like all right, I just want to be happy. Let's go do something. And things like that.

Speaker 2 [00:23:39] Yeah. I think it's overall really good.

Speaker 1 [00:23:55] Mhm. Yeah. So what do you say? That the relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:24:00] I would say that. It changed me a lot. Just because I used to be like so, I used to not like really being touchy with anybody, even my friends. But because she was like, super clingy and like, when she was super clingy, even as my friend, I wouldn't mind it at all. And so I feel like with her, I got really used to being able to like hug.

Speaker 2 [00:24:28] Not just anybody like hug in general or like be a lot more physically affectionate instead of having like. I don't know. I'm sort of feeling kind of like gross towards you. Feeling well, I kind of like being hugged or...

Speaker 2 [00:24:47] You know, things like that.

Speaker 1 [00:24:49] Yeah. And what...

Speaker 1 [00:24:50] About...

Speaker 1 [00:24:51] What about your girlfriend? Do you think she changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:55] I think so.

Speaker 2 [00:24:57] She used to be a lot more. Well, as I saw it, like, less confident in herself.

Speaker 2 [00:25:03] And...

Speaker 2 [00:25:05] Like, she's pretty. She's smart.

Speaker 2 [00:25:08]. What's it called?

Speaker 2 [00:25:09] She's super funny. So I like. I see her being herself with other people a lot more just because I know that back when we were friends, she would really switch personalities, like, with me, and she'll be like, super funny and all that. But with other people she'll be like super quiet. And now she's like. Growing out of her shell and a lot more confident. Which I could see.

Speaker 1 [00:25:45] And. This is a similar question, but is the person you were before the relationship the same as the person you are now?

Speaker 2 [00:25:54] I feel like in some cases I do carry. My old self with me still. But I feel like I'm completely different now.

Speaker 2 [00:26:07] Just because we because it was a relationship that started when we were kind of young.

Speaker 2 [00:26:15] I like. Obviously I started maturing a lot more.

Speaker 2 [00:26:21] But now that we're getting into being adults, our relationship is also maturing and I'm maturing. I have more responsibilities and all that. And I feel like.

Speaker 2 [00:26:33] My what's called?...

Speaker 2 [00:26:36] My thought process on a lot of things are a lot more like it's a lot more healthier instead of just like, you know, making myself feel dumb or anything like that.

Speaker 2 [00:26:47] But yeah, I feel like I've changed a lot and I'm not really the same as I was before. And I'm glad she still likes me because, you know, it's difficult to be like transitioning with someone throughout your life.

Speaker 1 [00:27:00] Yeah, definitely. And what about your girlfriend? Do you think she's the same before the relationship as you are now?

Speaker 2 [00:27:10] Honestly, I don't sometimes...

Speaker 2 [00:27:14] No, actually, no, she's not. She's not the same. And I do still like her, you know? But know kind of like what I said with me. We do carry our old selves with us. Sometimes they might pick through.

Speaker 2 [00:27:28] But...

Speaker 2 [00:27:29] I feel like she's a lot more different now. Looks a lot more confident. Just a lot of the unhealthy friendships she had before us. Not anymore. And she has a lot of her better friends now that, like, you know, uplift and all that. So I feel like she's a lot different...

Speaker 2 [00:27:51] Now than before.

Speaker 1 [00:27:59] What do you say? That you feel safe in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:28:02] Oh, on this relationship? Yes. I do feel safe

Speaker 1 [00:28:07] And why do you say so? Because safety could be any sort of way for you define it.

Speaker 2 [00:28:11] Yeah.

Speaker 2 [00:28:12] Just. ah what's it called? Just cause, like, emotionally wise, I feel like I could go to her and cry, and she'd still asked me why, but she'll let me, like, cry it all out. And then afterwards, I could tell her, you know. Or I can be.

Speaker 2 [00:28:31] What's it called?

Speaker 2 [00:28:34] I say it like childish.

Speaker 2 [00:28:36] You know? Mm hmm...

Speaker 2 [00:28:38] And she'll still. Like me, even though I'm acting like really annoying or things like that or I don't know, I can just really show a lot of my emotions without having her judge me for it.

Speaker 2 [00:28:52] And I just feel safe, like in general, Like...

Speaker 2 [00:28:55] I don't know...

Speaker 2 [00:28:56] Physically safe, mentally safe.

Speaker 1 [00:29:02] That's so cool. All right. So I'm going to share my screen for these three questions.

Speaker 1 [00:29:17] All right. Can you see it?

Speaker 2 [00:29:19] Yeah. Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:29:20] I was going to say no in line, but.

Speaker 1 [00:29:24] All right. So the first one, I will be taking notes on the side. Okay. So for the first one, let me. Yeah. Okay. So for the first one, for these three questions is going to be a Likert scale. So I'm going to read you the statement and then you're going to rate it based on the scale. So my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:29:53] It's going to be like 7 or 8.

Speaker 1 [00:29:58] Down up.

Speaker 1 [00:29:58] 7.5.

Speaker 1 [00:30:00] So why not a seven? And. Yeah, let's start there.

Speaker 2 [00:30:07] Why not a seven?

Speaker 2 [00:30:09] What's it called? I don't know. I just chose around this number. Just because it really is on the higher end of it. I do feel like she listens to me.

Speaker 2 [00:30:21] Most of the time. And I do think that's true. Especially very true.

Speaker 2 [00:30:30] One of my cousins just came. It okay though

Speaker 2 [00:30:36] One answer, and I don't think it'll go any lower than that. But it is on the higher end just because, um.

Speaker 2 [00:30:42] Uh huh. Was like saying...

Speaker 2 [00:30:49] What were I going to say? Oh, my God. I got distracted. Sorry, Oh, like even if, like, you know, really dramatic, we're just going to be a little selfish and think about our own feelings after those kind of things pass through. She'll be very understanding.

Speaker 2 [00:31:09] You know...

Speaker 2 [00:31:11] But I do think about like, you know, there's moments where.

Speaker 2 [00:31:14] We aren't very...

Speaker 2 [00:31:16] Listening to each other and all that.

Speaker 2 [00:31:19] So I wouldn't really, really high, like every single one be like an open ear or she'll be.

Speaker 2 [00:31:25] But when we do come to each other with like, you know, then we. Yeah. So 7.5 and 8 was good from 7.99.

Speaker 1 [00:31:41] So next one: My partner usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker 2 [00:31:46] Yeah, I think that would be like an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:31:50] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:31:54] And why not a seven?

Speaker 2 [00:31:57] Not a seven, Because most of the time, yeah, she does. Like, you know, if I am feeling a little more emotional, then she'll definitely be there for me.

Speaker 2 [00:32:09] And. On...

Speaker 2 [00:32:16] Oh seven before. Just cause. Like if I am feeling a little more emotional, she'll be there for me.

Speaker 2 [00:32:24] And she'll like, you know...

Speaker 2 [00:32:27] If I'm feeling angry, she'll, like, try to calm me down.

Speaker 2 [00:32:31] Not a hurdle like protocol or, I don't know.

Speaker 2 [00:32:37] Just insecurities too most of the time.

Speaker 2 [00:32:41] She'll really be like, Oh, what I do to help all that, you know?

Speaker 2 [00:32:45] And it's not fully announced, just cause I'm. There are moments where, you know, she's going to need her space. And like in the moment that I'm having trouble, she may also have some trouble with her family or any situation. So it's like it's always there, but, It's definitely, definitely there.

Speaker 1 [00:33:07] What about in those situations, as you just mentioned, how do you guys like if you need maybe reassurance, for example, but she's having her own issues. How do you handle that?

Speaker 2 [00:33:19] Most of the time, like with me, I'm like, I'll have like a little her in my head and be like, okay, what would she say if I'm saying this to myself? Like, I'm beating myself up because I think I'm ugly. And she'll probably be like, Oh, you're so pretty, but I'm probably going to still be feeling that way. Like, I just have to think through my emotions a lot more and try not to really like depend on her in those moments just because I also don't want to trouble her. So I just try to make myself feel better, like I give more effort towards myself.

Speaker 2 [00:33:56] To feel better...

Speaker 1 [00:33:59] Love her. All right. Next one. How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:34:06] I think. I think very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:34:09] Okay.

Speaker 2 [00:34:09] Until we're married, I'll probably be completely satisfied. But very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:34:14] Mm hmm. All right. Right. Let me stop sharing.

Speaker 1 [00:34:32] All right. We're almost done.

Speaker 1 [00:34:44] All right. So this is. More like a sensitive question, so feel free to let me know if it's too sensitive for you, but I would like to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. Would you like to continue? It's only two questions.

Speaker 2 [00:35:05] Okay

Speaker 1 [00:35:06] So these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker 2 [00:35:08] Oh, no. Not very much. Just because, like I said before. We don't really have our own privacy. Because we live with our parents.

Speaker 2 [00:35:21] So it's not like, you know, we're corn dogs, like, everyday. But yeah, we. Yeah. Not often.

Speaker 1 [00:35:32] Like within a month. How much would you say? Like just around a number.

Speaker 2 [00:35:37] Like within this past like three months. Mhm. I mean.

Speaker 2 [00:35:46] I'm saving myself somewhere.

Speaker 2 [00:35:48] Oh, no, no, no. Um...

Speaker 1 [00:35:53] So how satisfied would you say you are with your sex life?

Speaker 2 [00:35:57] Oh, I mean, honestly, me, I don't really. Like, obviously we're all going to get like, you know, urges and all that or horny whatever. But I feel like, you know, I'm okay with not doing anything like that. Focus on the girl and that'll be enough for me until we do have our own privacy.

Speaker 2 [00:36:23] So we get like space, so I'm okay with it?

Speaker 1 [00:36:27] Cool. All right. So moving on. Last question.

Speaker 1 [00:36:32] All right. So did the relationship fulfill your expectations?

Speaker 2 [00:36:37] Mm, I think so...

Speaker 2 [00:36:39] I mean, I didn't honestly, when I was younger, I did have, like, some kind of expectation for it. But now it's like, you know, we'll keep going.

Speaker 2 [00:36:50] Until we can I guess, you know, I'm just...

Speaker 2 [00:36:56] I'm just thinking about it like, now it's prevalent as long as we're together now.

Speaker 1 [00:37:03] You said when you were younger, you had expectations. Okay, tell me more about that.

Speaker 2 [00:37:08] Just, just. I felt like I was partially, like, with my family, too. Or just because I thought that we'd be probably, like, married by [16-20] or something.

Speaker 2 [00:37:18] I'm [16-20]. Yeah. I'm still not married. But you know.

Speaker 2 [00:37:23] Or like, my family would really like or look like, you know...

Speaker 2 [00:37:29] Or not that she has to come out any time soon. You know, I'm fine with that. But I used to be like, you know, I want a relationship that both of us are out.

Speaker 2 [00:37:39] Just because it was a little more difficult back then. Like, I wanted to, like, you know, show everything, like my world...

Speaker 2 [00:37:48] everything like that. But then I'm like, chill. I like a little more privacy now.

Speaker 1 [00:37:57] All right. So we're close to wrapping up. And I would just like to summarize what we have talked about in the past hour. So, again, I have details here. Please. Just like an overview. So you're [16-20] years old. You've been together [6-10 years].

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:38:52] And then, in terms of comparing the quality of your relationship to that of your friends, overall, your friends relationships are not as long term as you guys. then. You not have had a romantic partners in the past. What makes a relationship high quality. You said communication and trust. And there may be doubt, but as long as trust is in place and then low quality would be constant and unhealthy, arguing, not forgiving, not understanding the other point of view and just not know trust. The most important things in a relationship is being able to bond with each others parents. So like sibling outings. Bonding with the people your partner is close with. Talking about insecurities and being each other's best friend. For you love is. Doing the little things for each other. No matter what. And being the first person to thinking of being her.

Speaker 1 [00:40:13] The first person you would think of when good things happen and having like a healthy obsession with each other.

Speaker 2 [00:40:25] That was a good wording. I'm being like.

Speaker 1 [00:40:31] You said that love is is a is it is an important thing in a relationship. And there are certain points where you don't like your partner, like you have disagreements, but you're still choosing them. And that kind of is along the lines of trust.

Speaker 1 [00:40:54] You know, your partner loves you because every time she thinks about you, she gets you things she feeds, feeds into your obsessions like comics and notebooks and..

Speaker 2 [00:41:11] so much. Um, yeah.

Speaker 1 [00:41:13] then challenges. Yeah. So there are definitely disagreements, but forgiving each other and asking each other questions, just reflecting on your emotions,

having empathy and letting things out helps. You said to your partner and you don't really fight, but just disagreements, you get upset.

Speaker 1 [00:41:35] Long distance can also contribute to that conflict.

Speaker 1 [00:41:42] And other ways that you maintain your relationship. Thus making the designated days to go out with each other like eating out together. You said that the relationship is good for you. It is a good distraction with like knowing that it is still a responsibility wanting to hang out. You said that the relationship did change you and your partner.

Speaker 1 [00:42:20] And you would say that the person you were before their relationship. In some cases is the same. But you have matured over time with their relationship as well as she has. And for her, she is not the same person. But she does carry her old self at times. But she does have better friends, you mentioned. And yet you feel safe in the relationship emotionally because you're able to be vulnerable and childish, as you said. Without judgment in terms of the likert scale you said for. My partner usually really listens to me. You said a 7.5. For my partner is usually responsive to my needs. You said an eight.

Speaker 1 [00:43:24] And for how satisfied are you with your relationship? You said complete or not, you said very satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:43:37] And you said that the relationship did fulfill your expectations. But besides the fact that you expected to be married by [16-20], but that did change.

Speaker 1 [00:43:51] Yeah, that's pretty much. Is there anything else you'd like to add?

Speaker 2 [00:43:55] Um. Now think that sounds pretty cool.

Speaker 1 [00:44:01] So thank you so much. Now, before we end, I want to talk to you about how we handle the data. So as a research project, we want to be as ethically transparent as possible. And so I wanted to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with. So there are two options. The first option is that the transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. Or the other option? If you were being bolder, the whole transcript can be shared. But with the removal of sensitive and overly identifying details, so will be anonymized. Although in this option, there is a very, very minimal chance that someone who knows you very well can piece together the details in the transcript. Narrowed down who among their colleagues They believe it is right. So although, again, no sensitive information will be shared. So of these two options, which are you most comfortable with?

Speaker 2 [00:45:07] I think the first one is okay.

Speaker 1 [00:45:12] All right. So thank you again for participating in the study. I would like to let you know that this is also being done in the Philippines, Brazil, Netherlands, France and all over the US. So for this study to be successful, there's also one more thing I would like to ask you if that's okay with you. Can you recommend to people you're in your life as a nominator? We would ask them for additional couples that might be interested in the study, but we'll be asking them for couples that you don't know or interact with. And

this way we can get as diverse of a network we can get. So do you have anyone in mind? I'll read you. Give me one sec. I'll read you the requirements. And if anything rings the bell for you to tell me.

Speaker 1 [00:46:10] So a heterosexual couple who have been together 5 to 10 years of, I believe, high satisfaction.

Speaker 1 [00:46:20] Heterosexual couples who have been together 10 to 20 years with a high satisfaction heterosexual couple who have been together 20 plus years with low satisfaction. Yeah, those are the main ones. Anything. Ring the bell. Ring a bell on me?

Speaker 2 [00:46:36] I don't. I don't think so.

Speaker 1 [00:46:38] Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:46:40] No problem. Yeah. All right. So that's pretty much it. That concludes our interview. Do you have any questions for me?

Speaker 2 [00:46:47] No. Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:46:48] All right. So, yeah. Thank you so much. And have a rest. Have a good rest of your day.

Speaker 2 [00:46:53] Thank you. You too. Be good.